태극 1장

Taegeuk Il Jang · Geon ☰ · Heaven

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Step-by-step on your phone
visualtkd.com/taegeuk/

NA · 나

ra¹ — da¹

4 — **Momtong jireugi** — Middle punch — L · AP SEOGI

3 — **Arae makki** — Low block — R · AP SEOGI

준비 — **Junbi** — Ready — NARANHI

1 — **Arae makki** — Low block — L · AP SEOGI

2 — **Momtong jireugi** — Middle punch — R · AP SEOGI

5 — **Arae makki** — Low block — L · AP KUBI

18 — **Momtong jireugi** — Middle punch — R · AP KUBI

기합 KIHAP

GEON · 건 · HEAVEN

The first Taegeuk represents heaven and light, the source of all creation. It is built from the two most basic stances and simple, honest techniques, the foundation every later form grows from.

READING THE FOOTPRINTS

Ap seogi · walking stance. One natural step, feet almost in line.

Ap kubi · front stance. About 1½ steps long, one fist wide, front knee bent.

Ap chagi · front kick from the rear leg.

Red foot leads; the blue tick is the direction you face. Front-stance chips are filled.

ra² — da²

8 — **Momtong jireugi** — Middle punch — L · AP SEOGI

7 — **Momtong an makki** — Inside middle block — R · AP SEOGI

6 — **Momtong jireugi** — Middle punch — L · AP KUBI

9 — **Momtong an makki** — Inside middle block — L · AP SEOGI

10 — **Momtong jireugi** — Middle punch — R · AP SEOGI

11 — **Arae makki** — Low block — R · AP KUBI

17 — **Arae makki** — Low block — L · AP KUBI

PRACTICE NOTES

HOW THE DIAGRAM READS

You start at **na** facing **ga** (the bottom of the page). Figures on the left and right are seen from the side; centre figures face you going toward ga and show their back returning toward na. Horse- and crane-stance figures face the way the body faces.

ra³ — da³

16-2 — **Momtong jireugi** — Middle punch — L · AP SEOGI

16-1 — **Ap chagi** — Front kick — L · AP CHAGI

15 — **Eolgul makki** — High block — R · AP SEOGI

12 — **Momtong jireugi** — Middle punch — R · AP KUBI

13 — **Eolgul makki** — High block — L · AP SEOGI

14-1 — **Ap chagi** — Front kick — R · AP CHAGI

14-2 — **Momtong jireugi** — Middle punch — R · AP SEOGI

GA · 가

Taegeuk Il Jang · Full sequence

태극 1장 · 18 movements

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#	DIRECTION	STANCE	TECHNIQUE	INSTRUCTION
–	na	Naranhi seogi 나란히서기	Junbi 준비	Stand at na facing ga, feet parallel and one foot-width apart, fists in front of the belt.
1	da¹	Left ap seogi 앞서기	Arae makki 아래막기	Turn 90° left toward da¹, stepping the left foot into a left walking stance. Left low block.
2	da¹	Right ap seogi 앞서기	Momtong jireugi (bandae) 몸통지르기	Step forward with the right foot into a right walking stance. Right middle punch.
3	ra¹	Right ap seogi 앞서기	Arae makki 아래막기	Pivot 180° to the right toward ra¹, right walking stance. Right low block.
4	ra¹	Left ap seogi 앞서기	Momtong jireugi (bandae) 몸통지르기	Step forward into a left walking stance. Left middle punch.
5	ga	Left ap kubi 앞굽이	Arae makki 아래막기	Turn 90° left toward ga, stepping the left foot into a left front stance. Left low block.
6	ga	Left ap kubi 앞굽이	Momtong jireugi (baro) 몸통지르기	Hold the left front stance. Right middle punch (reverse punch).
7	ra²	Right ap seogi 앞서기	Momtong an makki 몸통안막기	Turn 90° right toward ra², right walking stance. Left inside middle block.
8	ra²	Left ap seogi 앞서기	Momtong jireugi (baro) 몸통지르기	Step forward into a left walking stance. Right middle punch.
9	da²	Left ap seogi 앞서기	Momtong an makki 몸통안막기	Pivot 180° to the left toward da², left walking stance. Right inside middle block.
10	da²	Right ap seogi 앞서기	Momtong jireugi (baro) 몸통지르기	Step forward into a right walking stance. Left middle punch.
11	ga	Right ap kubi 앞굽이	Arae makki 아래막기	Turn 90° right toward ga, right front stance. Right low block.
12	ga	Right ap kubi 앞굽이	Momtong jireugi (baro) 몸통지르기	Hold the right front stance. Left middle punch (reverse punch).
13	da³	Left ap seogi 앞서기	Eolgul makki 얼굴막기	Turn 90° left toward da³, left walking stance. Left high block.
14-1	da³	Right leg 앞차기	Ap chagi 앞차기	Right front kick, striking with the ball of the foot.
14-2	da³	Right ap seogi 앞서기	Momtong jireugi (bandae) 몸통지르기	Land forward in a right walking stance. Right middle punch.
15	ra³	Right ap seogi 앞서기	Eolgul makki 얼굴막기	Pivot 180° to the right toward ra³, right walking stance. Right high block.
16-1	ra³	Left leg 앞차기	Ap chagi 앞차기	Left front kick, striking with the ball of the foot.
16-2	ra³	Left ap seogi 앞서기	Momtong jireugi (bandae) 몸통지르기	Land forward in a left walking stance. Left middle punch.
17	na	Left ap kubi 앞굽이	Arae makki 아래막기	Turn 90° toward na, stepping the left foot into a left front stance. Left low block.
18	na	Right ap kubi 앞굽이	Momtong jireugi (bandae) 몸통지르기	Step forward into a right front stance. Right middle punch with a kihap.

Official references

KUKKIWON · OFFICIAL SITE
Taegeuk 1 Jang
The form's official description, meaning and line.
visualtkd.com/go/kukkiwon-t1

KUKKIWON · OFFICIAL SITE
Poomsae index
Every official poomsae, Taegeuk 1–8 and the black-belt forms.
visualtkd.com/go/kukkiwon-poomsae

YOUTUBE · VIDEO
Taegeuk 1 Jang, full performance
Kukkiwon Digital Encyclopedia, published by Mookas TV.
visualtkd.com/go/video-t1

YOUTUBE · CHANNEL
Kukkiwon World Taekwondo Headquarters
The official Kukkiwon channel.
visualtkd.com/go/kukkiwon-youtube

WORLD TAEKWONDO · PDF
Poomsae Competition Rules and Interpretation
In force from 30 September 2024; how poomsae are judged.
visualtkd.com/go/wt-poomsae-rules